The Jewel Garland Praise of Lokeśvara

Lokeśvararatnamālāstava · Toh 1174 · Derge Tengyur
འཇིག་རྟེན་དབང་ཕྱུག་གི་བསྟོད་པ་རཏྣ་པ་ཆོའེ་ཕྲེང་བ

The Jewel Garland Praise of Lokeśvara, in Sanskrit Lokeśvararatnamālāstava and in Tibetan Jikten Wangchuk gi Töpa Rinpoché Trengwa, is a hymn in verse to Lokeśvara, the bodhisattva of compassion better known as Avalokiteśvara. It praises him as one who, though single, appears in many forms to those he trains, like the moon reflected in many vessels of water. In the manner of the Kāraṇḍavyūha sūtra, it tells how the gods revered by other traditions, among them Maheśvara, Brahmā, the sun and moon, Sarasvatī, Vāyu and Varuṇa, were brought forth from his body to tame their followers. Further stanzas extol his cosmic power, his beauty and his resolve to remain in existence for the sake of beings, hailing him as Victor and Sovereign of the Earth, and the hymn closes with a dedication of merit. Its colophon names the great paṇḍita Vanaratna of eastern India as its author, and says it was translated in his presence by the monk Gyatsö Dé at the great vihāra of Śrī Gopīcandra beside Patan in Nepal; it is Toh 1174 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of praises (stotra).

In Sanskrit: Lokeśvararatnamālastavonāma
In Tibetan: The Jewel Garland Praise of Lokeśvara

Homage to Lokanātha (Protector of the World).

Lokeśvara, your stainless mind is moist with tenderness and compassion;
In meaning and in word you clearly teach the knowledge of the paths, the knowledge of all, and the rest;
Your body is complete and perfectly pure:
To you who sport as lord of surpassing wisdom I bow my head.

Though one, you appear as many according to the differences among those to be trained,
Like the hare-marked moon present in vessels of water;
And since you plainly follow after the good of others, therefore,
How wonderful! A body of supreme and marvelous miracles is fitting for you.

To fully awaken and tame the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas),
From the place of the graceful forehead of your full-moon face
You brought forth the god Maheśvara (Śiva), hidden there;
Thus you are god beyond the gods, and great lord of men.

From your shoulders, which bear the great mark of being well rounded,
The god Pitāmaha (Brahmā) was brought forth outward,
In order to tame and fully awaken the followers of the Lotus-born (Brahmā):
To Lokeśvara, chief of lords, I bow my head.

In order to tame and bring to understanding the followers of Viṣṇu,
The Accomplisher of Existence too was brought forth from the heart of Padmapāṇi (Lotus in Hand);
This one is the very lord of existence, and therefore
You alone are the Supreme Person (Puruṣottama); there is no other supreme one.

For those who, devoted to the sun and moon, have zealously taken up their worship and service,
In order to show them the truth, from your beautiful sapphire-blue eyes
The moon and the sun were brought forth: to the one who dispels
The inner darkness of the eyes of those on earth I pay homage.

Here, for those who devote their service and worship to Śrī,
In order to tame them and truly awaken them, this Blessed Sarasvatī
Was brought forth from the tips of your canine teeth, O Son of the Victors:
To the one who grants the fruit of the wisdom they long for, I pay homage.

To tame the followers of the Wind and accomplish the inexhaustible path,
This one was then brought forth from the mouth of Lokanātha:
Vāyu, god of the wind, supreme master of those born on earth,
Who grants the fruit of the four modes of deportment: to him I pay homage.

To tame the followers of Varuṇa, and so that those who long for the path of peace
May truly understand it, from the belly of the Son of the Sugatas
Was truly brought forth Varuṇa too, lord of the waters:
To the one who swiftly grants the fruit of mastery over all desires, I pay homage.

To tame and bring to full accomplishment those who long for fitting fruits and the like,
From the lotus of your feet, which bear the most supreme marks,
Was brought forth the one renowned as the Blessed Vasundharā (the Earth):
To that peerless Protector of the three worlds I pay homage.

Though you are freed from existence, you truly remain in it
Out of sheer love for the host of sentient beings, living in the ways of existence,
Thinking, "Steadfast until existence ends, may I remain forever":
To you, supreme in great and holy resolve, I bow.

The world systems that appear as far as space extends
You tread down with the sole of a single foot;
The fierce fire of craving for existence, blazing at the end of the eon,
Was quenched by the force of the wind of your breath.

With the threatening forefinger that you hold pointing upward
You set Meru's many terraces quaking, and lifting
Even the ocean's waters in the hollow of a fingernail, you left none behind:
How wonderful! Where but in you is power such as this ever seen?

Supremely tender and gentle, truly showing the beauty of the young moon,
Is this supreme body of yours that of a youthful maiden?
Undismayed and never weary in subduing the terrifying and the fierce,
And destroying the māras so hard to tame: such is your way.

O noble one, like the strings of round curls of a great being,
Those supremely beautiful curling locks that grow upon your head,
Like a wreath of smoke from the firewood of the afflictions
Set ablaze by the fire of reality, appear on you, Stainless One.

With but a little of your moonlight streaming forth, you pervade a little
The lovely light, with its slender sliver as the dark fortnight wanes away,
Of that moon which is longed for throughout existence:
From but a few of your rays it brings beauty to every mind.

You overthrow the ways of those who walk together on evil paths,
And teaching humans and nonhumans according to their thoughts, path upon path,
You bring them to true attainment by your supreme conduct for the good of others:
To the beautiful Victor, Lord of the Earth, I bow.

Though you abide neither in existence nor in nirvāṇa,
Benefactor who has entered the union of luminosity and self-blessing,
You still the nonvirtue of all beings without exception:
To the Victor, Lord of the Earth, beautiful with virtue, I bow.

Wholly wreathed in garlands of the boundless light of your family,
You have attained the accordant joy that is born
From holding the lotus in your own hand; beautiful with true joy and bliss,
O Victor, Lord of the Earth, homage to you!

Supreme over all, arisen from the dharmadhātu (the sphere of reality), lord who is compassion itself,
You who have perfectly completed the accumulations of virtue and the rest,
Who by the power of having abandoned conceptual thought teach through sound:
To the beautiful Victor, Lord of the Earth, I bow.

With the hundredfold bliss in which suchness and non-suchness are not two
You fill to overflowing; speaking hundreds of discourses on the Dharma
Most truly and with reason, you are wholly beautiful:
To the supreme King, Sovereign of the Earth, I bow.

The supreme one's own body streams forth to beings,
Made most beautiful by lotus eyes:
King of the swift and supreme liberation of all sentient beings without exception,
Holy Sovereign of the Earth, to you I pay homage.

As supreme emanation and enjoyment bodies you delight in the good of others;
You delight in upholding the Dharma of stainless emptiness;
Lord who holds the sublime accomplishment born of perfect awakening,
Supreme King, Sovereign of the Earth, to you I pay homage.

In the ocean of the supreme and holy innate (sahaja), all that you speak
From the doorway of your moonlike face, every word and phrase,
Is the choicest of ornaments, in accord with the characteristics of nirvāṇa:
Holy Lord, King of the Earth, homage to you!

From the composing of this Jewel Garland Praise of Lokeśvara
By the glorious Vanaratnapāda,
Whatever pure virtue he has gained,
Through that very virtue may the world become wholly good.

This Jewel Garland Praise is complete.

It was composed by the venerable Vanaratna, great paṇḍita of eastern India. In the presence of that same great scholar, the monk called Gyatsö Dé

translated it at the great vihāra of Śrī Gopīcandra, beside the great city of Yerang (Patan) in Nepal.

Translator's Notes

• The gods brought forth from Lokeśvara's body (Maheśvara from the forehead, Brahmā from the shoulders, the sun and moon from the eyes, Sarasvatī from the teeth, Vāyu from the mouth, Varuṇa from the belly and the earth goddess from the feet) follow the Kāraṇḍavyūha sūtra. There Nārāyaṇa (Viṣṇu) comes from the heart. The name used here, srid sgrub, is not a standard rendering, so it is translated literally as "the Accomplisher of Existence".
Readings: mi yid bang phyug is read as mi yi dbang phyug, "lord of men"; lha sbas, literally "god hidden", is taken to mean that Maheśvara lay hidden in the forehead; gnyen gshin is read as mnyen gshin, "tender and gentle"; the terse mi ldongs ci yang dub pa is read as "undismayed and never weary".
• The closing verse is the author's dedication of merit, read as a wish. The translator, the monk Gyatsö Dé, is not otherwise identified, so his name is given in Tibetan phonetics.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.